

Use-Case Flow Specification: Virtual Technical Conference Platform

Problem Description: This document details the use-case flow for submitting a paper to the conference platform, covering the main success scenario and an alternate flow for handling invalid file uploads, as part of the requirements engineering process for the double-blind review and scheduling system.

Use Case: UC-01 Submit Paper

Primary Actor: Conference Author

Preconditions

1. The Author is registered and logged into the conference portal.
2. The call for papers is currently open (submission deadline has not passed).

Postconditions

1. The paper is stored in the system with a unique submission ID and status "Submitted".
2. An anonymized copy of the manuscript exists and is available for reviewer assignment.

Main Success Scenario

1. Author logs into the portal and selects "Submit Paper."
2. System displays a submission form requesting title, abstract, track, and manuscript file.
3. Author fills in the metadata fields and uploads the manuscript file (PDF).
4. System validates the file format and size.
5. System includes UC-02 (Anonymize Manuscript): author headers and metadata are stripped from the PDF to create a blind copy.
6. System assigns a unique submission ID and stores the paper with status "Submitted."
7. System confirms the submission to the Author on screen and by email receipt.
8. Use case ends successfully.

Alternate Flow: Invalid File

1. At step 4, the system detects an invalid file format or a file exceeding the size limit.
 - a. System displays an error message specifying the accepted format (PDF) and maximum size.
 - b. Author is prompted to correct and re-upload the file.
 - c. If the Author does not resubmit a valid file within the session, the draft submission is discarded and the Author is notified by email.